SALTBUSH SHEETS · FREE GUIDE

10 ways to cut your fuel bill in Australia

Practical things you can do this week. General information, checked 1 November 2026.

1 Check the price before you fill

Prices can differ a lot between servos in the same suburb. Use your state's official source (see the list below). Supermarket dockets and member discounts can help too; compare them with the cheapest nearby price.

2 Learn your city's price cycle

In some cities, petrol prices rise and fall in a pattern. Perth has had a weekly unleaded cycle, and FuelWatch shows tomorrow's prices so you can pick your day. Cycles in other big cities have changed in 2026, so check the ACCC's current buying tips. Diesel doesn't follow these cycles.

3 Buy the fuel your car needs

Check the owner's manual or the label inside the fuel flap. If your car is fine on regular unleaded, premium mostly costs you more at the pump.

4 Keep tyres at the right pressure

The recommended pressures are on the tyre placard (often inside the driver's door) or in the manual. Under-inflated tyres make the engine work harder. Check them when they're cold, about once a month.

5 Take off what you're not using

Empty roof racks and boxes add drag, and a boot full of gear adds weight. Both use more fuel, especially on the highway.

6 Drive smoothly

Gentle acceleration, looking ahead so you brake less, and a steady speed all use less fuel. On the highway, cruise control helps hold that steady speed.

7 Don't idle longer than you need to

An idling engine burns fuel for zero km. If you're parked and waiting, turning the engine off (when it's safe) saves fuel.

8 Combine trips

A cold engine uses more fuel. One loop that covers the shop, the drop-off and the errands usually beats three separate short trips.

9 Keep up with servicing

Follow the service schedule in your manual. A well-maintained car runs as it was designed to, and a service is a good time to have the tyres checked as well.

10 Track your L/100km

Once you know your normal fuel use, a sudden rise is a sign to check your tyres or book a service. Logging each fill also shows whether cheap-day fills are really paying off. The Car & Fuel Tracker works this out for you.

Official fuel price sources by state

WA: FuelWatch (website and app), with tomorrow's prices as well as today's

NSW and ACT: FuelCheck (website and app)

Victoria: Servo Saver, in the Service Victoria app

Tasmania: FuelCheck TAS (website and app)

Northern Territory: MyFuel NT (website)

Queensland and SA: the state government publishes a list of approved fuel price apps and websites

See what your car really costs

Free calculator with your own numbers, then the Car & Fuel Tracker (A$17 one-off) works out your real cost per km from every fill.

jj-1818.github.io/saltbush-sheets/car-cost-calculator.html

General information only, not financial or tax advice. Fuel price rules and apps can change, so follow the official source for your state; the ACCC publishes current petrol buying tips. © Saltbush Sheets. Prices in AUD.